

LEARN, SPEAK, SHINE!



QUESTION OF THE DAY

- ✓ Every student answers one question.
- ✓ Builds confidence and gives equal chance to all.



SENTENCE FORMATION PRACTICE

- ✓ Create your own sentences.
- ✓ Improves grammar + vocabulary



SPEAKING ROUND

- ✓ Share your answers aloud.
- ✓ Boosts fluency & removes hesitation



FEEDBACK & CORRECTIONS

- ✓ Trainer guides on grammar & pronunciation.
- ✓ Encourages progress with positive motivation



English Proficiency Program

INTERACTIVE | PRACTICAL | CONFIDENCE-BUILDING

OCTOBER 27

English Batch 02:30 PM

Tutor: Sapna Gupta

Pendown: Keen Learner

Question of the day

What's your midnight craving?

- ❖ What food (or sometimes drink) do you most strongly want to eat when it's midnight?

Topic of the Day:

➤ Articles (A, An, The)

➤ Articles:

- Articles are small words — a, an, the — used before nouns to show whether we're talking about something specific or general.
- They help show whether the noun is general or specific.
- Nouns can refer to people, places, or things.

Article	Used for	Example
a	Singular, general nouns (consonant sound)	a pen
an	Singular, general nouns (vowel sound)	an orange
the	Specific nouns (singular or plural)	the book, the apples
(no article)	Plural/general ideas	Dogs are loyal.

✓ Articles – “a”

- ✓ Used before singular nouns beginning with a consonant sound.
- ✓ Refers to any one item, not a specific one.

Remember:

Even if a word starts with a vowel **letter**, check the **sound**.

✓ a university ✓

- The word “university” starts with the /ju:/ sound (as in you), which is a consonant sound, not a vowel sound.
- So we use “a”, not “an”

✓ a umbrella ✗

- The word “umbrella” starts with the /ʌ/ sound (uh), which is a vowel sound, so we use “an”, not “a”.
- ✓ an umbrella

Examples:

- I saw a cat in the garden. (not a specific cat)
- She wants to buy a laptop. (any laptop)

✓ Articles – “An”

- ✓ Used before singular nouns beginning with a vowel sound (a, e, i, o, u).
- ✓ Also used when the first sound is a silent ‘h’ (like in “hour”).

Remember:

- The sound matters more than the letter.
- an honest man  (silent “h”)

Examples:

- He ate an orange.
 - She saw an owl on the tree.
 - I’ll be there in an hour.
-

Articles – “The”

- ✓ Used when talking about specific or known people, places, or things.
- ✓ It can be used with singular or plural nouns and with both consonant and vowel sounds.
- ✓ *Use “the” when it’s clear which person or thing you are talking about.*

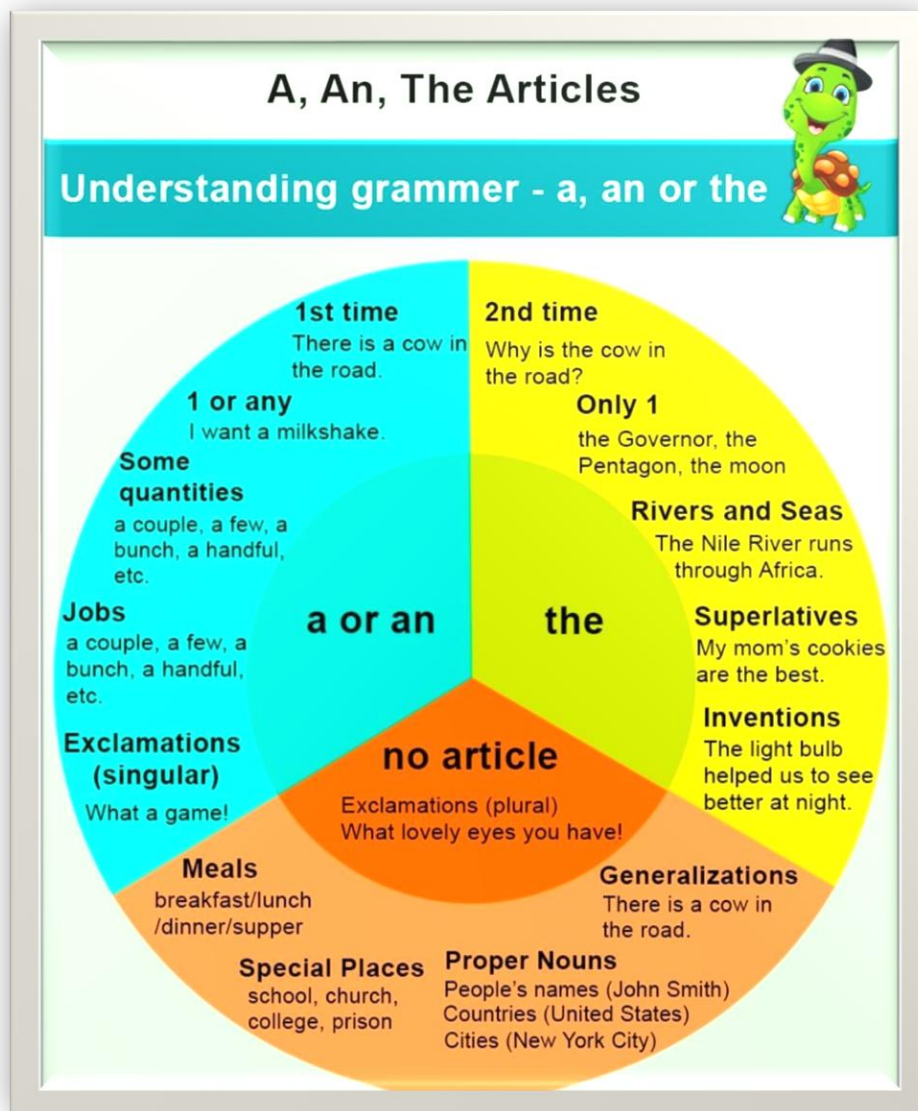
Articles with Plural Nouns (“The” or “No Article”)

- ✓ For **general plural nouns**, use **no article**.
→ *I like animals.* 
- ✓ For **specific plural nouns**, use **the**.
→ *The cats are sleeping.* 
→ *The eggs are fresh.* 
 - *No article = general idea*
 - *The = specific or known group*

Examples:

- The book on the desk is mine. (specific book)
- We visited the Eiffel Tower. (specific place)
- She likes the blue dress. (specific one among choices)
- Unique things: the earth, the sky, the internet.

An image is worth a thousand words.



A, THE, ZERO ARTICLE

test-english.com

A/AN	USES	EXAMPLES
	First mention	I saw an old woman and a dog in the park.
	Jobs	Paula is a teacher.
THE	Descriptions	Paris is an interesting city.
	USES	EXAMPLES
	Second mention	I saw a man and a dog. The man was old.
	Specific things	The children are in the garden.
	Only one thing	The moon looks beautiful today.
	Common places	We are going to the park.
	Superlatives	He is the best student in the class.
ZERO ARTICLE	Musical instruments	My daughter plays the violin.
	USES	EXAMPLES
	General meaning	I don't like children (=children in general).
	Meals	What time do you have breakfast ?
	Years, months, days	2005 was a great year.
	TV	There's a good film on TV .
	Languages, school subjects	He doesn't speak English . I study biology .
	Next, last	We went to the theater last week.



Mind the Topic

- ✓ "The" is only articles use with Singular as well as Plural
 - ❖ **the boy** (singular)
 - ❖ **the boys** (plural)
- ✓ In articles the **sound** matters more than the letter.

-
- ❖ **a university** → / sound (consonant sound)
 - ❖ **an hour** → /sound (vowel sound)

✓ *General vs. Specific Nouns*

1. **“A student”** — used when talking about any one student (not specific)

- **Call a student from class nine.**

→ (Any one student — not specified who.)

2. **“The student”** — used when talking about a specific student

We use **“the”** when both the speaker and listener know **which student** we mean.

- **Call the student who wears red specs from class nine.**

→ (We are specifying *which* student — the one with red spectacles.)

✓ **Ref Video**

https://youtu.be/RDkx4J-QY?si=h_yJ4ZT-DRt1fyKh